TWO-WAY DUAL LANGUAGE PROGRAM

ALIEF ISD
Parent Information

Welcome to the Two-Way Dual Language Program!



Goals of this presentation

- Provide an overview of the T**wo-Way Dual Language Program in AISD.**
- Inform about the unique opportunity for your student to participate in this program.
- Share program model, goals, components and effective strategies that make this a successful program where students become **bilingual, biliterate and multicultural in Spanish and English.**

OUR PROGRAM


"The limits of my language mean the limits of my world"
"Los límites de mi idioma son los límites de mi mundo"
-Ludwig Wittgenstein
DUAL LANGUAGE PROGRAM
ALIEF



Will My Child Learn
Spanish ?

Will My Child Learn
English ?

Through hardwork and dedication our students CAN learn BOTH!

Two-Way Dual Language Program

Offers the unique opportunity to

- ➔ Learn to speak, read, write and think in English and Spanish
- ➔ Work with students from different cultures and backgrounds
- ➔ Learn both languages through different academic subjects
- ➔ Achieve better academic performance and higher income potential, even further cultural development
- ➔ Not only be global citizens, but also world leaders, with added professional development opportunities and achievements

TWDL Mission & Vision

Program Mission

The Alief Independent School District will provide ample opportunities for language and content development through systematic scaffolded instruction delivered by well-prepared teachers.

Program Vision

Students will develop positive cross-cultural attitudes and behaviors, advanced academic achievement and high levels of proficiency in listening, speaking, reading and writing in English and a second language (Spanish).

Additional Program Benefits

Intermediate/Middle School

- ➔ Access to Science-Technology- Engineering-Math Curriculum (STEM) through Project Based Learning (PBL)
- ➔ Access to Advanced Spanish in 7-8 grade
- ➔ Obtain college credit in Spanish in High School (AP Spanish exam)
- ➔ Added leadership opportunities



Alief ISD Two Way Dual Language Pathway

Bilingual model trajectory in the Two Way Dual Language Program

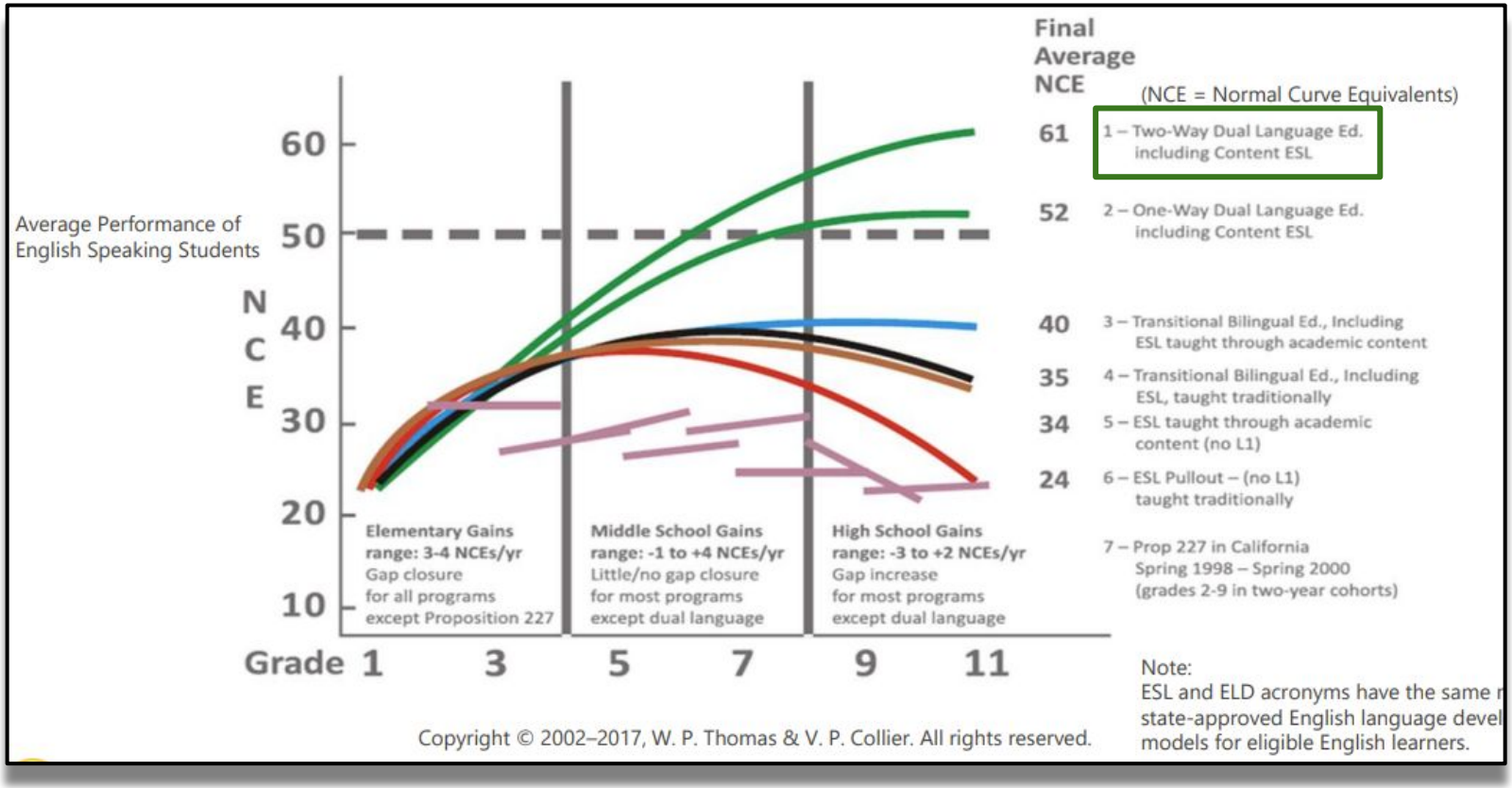
Elementary Grade
Kindergarten-Grade 6

Middle School
Grades 7-8
(Advanced Spanish through Successful AP Exam)

High School
Grades 9-12
Foreign Language Option Possibility of College Credit

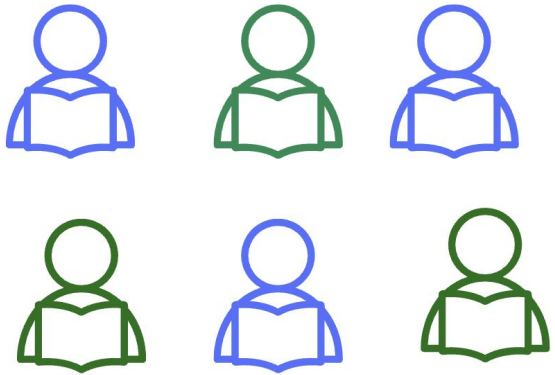


Research-Based Evidence



Who Can Participate?

- ➔ Limited number of Kindergarten students (5 years old as of 9/1/26, meet expectations, pass screener)
- ➔ Students zoned to any Alief ISD campus
- ➔ Out of district students who complete an out-of district transfer with Student Services
- ➔ Transfer students who are currently attending a Two-Way Dual Language Program (upon additional testing)



Student Expectations



- Attend school everyday
- Curious to learn
- Resilient
- Embrace others when speaking another language
- Flexible to accept other cultures & languages
- Self-control (follows classroom/campus rules & expectations)
- Complete all assignments and homework
- Ownership of learning

Parent Expectations



- ➔ **High parental support and involvement with the student and the program (English & Spanish / District Resources available)**
- ➔ Read aloud to your child in your native language everyday
- ➔ Parents are encouraged to volunteer at least 15 hours to support the program/campus
- ➔ Attend campus events
- ➔ Provide exposure to language opportunities (zoo, museums, libraries…)
- ➔ Long-term commitment to the TWDL program (7 years)

Elementary Schools with

Two-Way Dual Language Program

Even if your child does not attend one of these schools, they can participate!

- Martin ES
- Rees ES



Program Accessibility Plan

If your child is zoned to…	The Two-Way Dual Language Program School will be…
Alexander, Best, Boone, Bush, Collins, Cummings, Chambers, Chancellor, Horn, Kennedy, Landis, Liestman, Mahanay, Martin, Martinez, Smith, Sneed, Youens	**Martin ES**
Hearne, Heflin, Hicks, Holmquist, Jefferson, Outley, Petrosky, Rees	**Rees ES**

Potential Kindergarten Class Size



Spanish Dominant Kinder Homeroom	English Dominant Kinder Homeroom
25 students	25 students
1 teacher	1 teacher
1 classroom aide	1 classroom aide

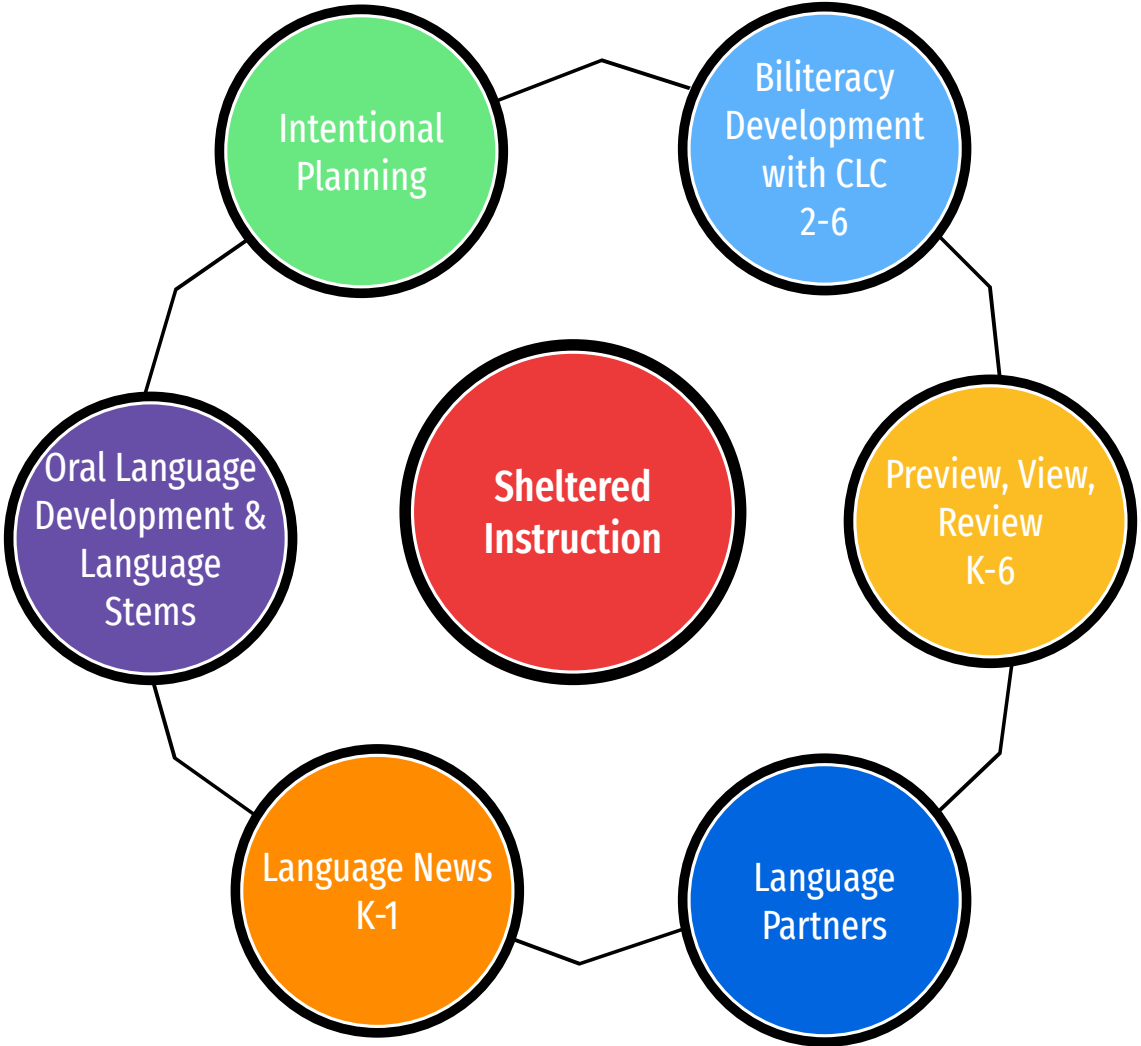
Language of Instruction

Subject Area	K-1	2nd-6th
Language Arts	Native Language (only time students are separated by L1)	**Spanish** & **English** (Equal Instructional time)
Science	**Spanish**	**Spanish**
Social Studies	**Spanish**	**Spanish**
Math	**English**	**English**
Enrichment classes (Art, Music, P.E., Health)	**English**	**English**

TWDL Sample KN Schedule

Time	Activity	Groups
7:45-8:10	Arrival/Attendance/Announcements/Community Circle	Homogeneous groups
8:10-8:55	Spanish Social Studies	Heterogeneous grouping with language partners
8:55-11:10	Spanish or English Reading Language Arts	Homogeneous groups
11:10-12:10	Lunch/Recess	Heterogeneous grouping with language partners
12:10-12:55	Spanish Science	Heterogeneous grouping with language partners
12:55-2:55	English Math	Heterogeneous grouping with language partners
2:55-3:10	Spanish or English Language News	Homogeneous groups
3:10-3:20	Announcement/Dismissal	Homogeneous groups

Pillars


Intentional Planning
Biliteracy Development with CLC 2-6
Oral Language Development & Language Stems
Sheltered Instruction
Preview, View, Review K-6
Language News K-1
Language Partners

Conclusions



1. Students **can** achieve high biliteracy and bilingual skill proficiency

2. Research shows Two-Way Dual Language students **can** outperform other programs in standardized tests

3. Students **can** gain interpersonal skills, global awareness and higher marketability

4. Students **can** communicate in two languages, greater self-esteem and accomplishment

Registration Steps

Step 1: Complete online application (Only 25 spots per homeroom available)

- Link
- Students will take a **language and pre-literacy screener** to determine eligibility

Step 2: Parents will be notified of program acceptance by the first week of May

* **Enrollment in Alief ISD is required**
https://www.aliefisd.net/enroll

Before saying goodbye...

Let’s see what kids have to say about being bilingual!



THANKS!

Program Director
Patricia Cantu

Yoliani Saud

Multilingual Programs

Bilingual/ESL District Specialist

Yoliani.SaudRojas@aliefisd.net

Esther Ríos

Multilingual Programs

Bilingual/ESL District Specialist

Esther.RiosRiveraMelo@aliefisd.net

